

Post-Operative Instructions

After Placement of Braces (Initial Bonding)

First 24–48 Hours

- Mild soreness and discomfort are normal.
- Use orthodontic wax to cover brackets that irritate cheeks or lips.
- Take OTC pain relievers as directed by your dentist.

Diet

- Avoid sticky, hard, or crunchy foods (gum, nuts, popcorn, ice).
- Eat soft foods such as yogurt, pasta, or scrambled eggs.
- Cut tougher foods into smaller pieces before chewing.

Oral Hygiene

- Brush gently after every meal using a soft-bristled brush.
- Use floss threaders or orthodontic floss to clean between teeth.
- Rinse with water or fluoride mouthwash.

Special Precautions

- Do not bite into whole apples, carrots, or hard bread.
- Contact the office if a bracket or wire becomes loose.